BrainsFirst

BRAIN PROFILE

Talent Portrait

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www.brainsfirst.com

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About BrainsFirst

At BrainsFirst, we believe that everyone possesses unique talents, and traditional methods of recognizing and developing talent can be improved. With our gamified assessment, the NeurOlympics, we assist both individuals and organizations in discovering, guiding, and nurturing talent, thereby enhancing workplace happiness and well-being.

Every brain on the right spot

Every brain is unique and possesses specific cognitive skills, allowing us all to excel. Whether it's speed, precision, or awareness of the environment, we all have strengths and challenges. How our brains are wired determines what we are good at, the tasks we enjoy, and in which jobs and work environments we function best.

The Brain Profile you have in front of you reveals where you naturally excel and how that may manifest in behavior. It provides insight into the type of work or environment that best suits you. Our goal is to guide everyone to the right position, the place that aligns with their brain, both in terms of the job and the work environment.

Your brain in action

If you engage in work that doesn't align with your Brain Profile, it doesn't necessarily mean you're bad at it. Throughout our lives, we develop various coping mechanisms for tasks that don't perfectly match our brain's preferences. This can turn out well, allowing you to excel in your work even if it doesn't directly align. However, the likelihood is that work closer to your Brain Profile requires less energy, you might grasp it more quickly and easily, and/or it could lead to better performance.

Your Brain Profile as a compass

Aligning your brain and job is very practical in nature. It starts with a step in the right direction. For instance, explore what you excel at, challenge yourself to acquire new skills, or consider what aligns better with your natural abilities. This way, you can gradually ensure that the match between your brain and work improves. Your Brain Profile is not an absolute endpoint. Consider it as a compass that guides you. It can lead you to surprising discoveries about yourself and your capabilities.

Less stress, more happiness at work

Years of research have demonstrated that when there is a match between the brain, job requirements, and the team, you experience less stress and develop a more efficient and enjoyable bond with your team. Additionally, it promotes diversity in the talent cycle, from recruitment and onboarding to retention and mobility.

Curious about our origins? Read our story on the website.
www.brainsfirst.com/our-story/

Zero talent waste

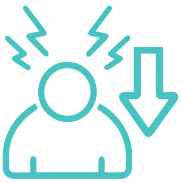
At BrainsFirst, we believe that everyone has talent. But it is all about the right fit!

You will perform at 85-95% of your potential in specific jobs, but you may struggle when the job is not the right fit for you.

Our goal is to help people and organizations reach *Zero talent waste*, where everyone has a job they excel at and enjoy.

We achieve this by matching your unique skills to the perfect job for you.

Discover your brain talent today!



19%
Stress level reduction

30%
More diversity in hiring

200%
Team productivity increase

Introduction

The Brain Profile - Talent Portrait

The Brain Profile is composed of two essential components: the **Talent Landscape** and the **Behavioral Cycle**. Together, they each contribute in their own way to the understanding of individual skills and work styles. In this Talent Portrait, you can discover how this manifests for you.

If you're looking to discover where your talents lie, perhaps for education, a first job, or a career switch, you'll primarily focus on the Talent Landscape.

If you have a clearer picture of the specific context of a task, job, or organization, or the daily activities involved, you'll pay more attention to your Natural Brain Preferences in the Behavioral Cycle.

The profile provides both a profound insight into unique skill sets and your Natural Brain Preferences. It also aids in identifying environments and roles where these strengths are best utilized.

The Talent Landscape

The Talent Landscape provides insight into your preferred directions regarding tasks, skills, and competencies. These talents are the building blocks that determine which tasks suit you best. Each position in the landscape represents a specific combination of skills, which determine whether someone will be successful or face challenges - these are called skill sets. Your position within this landscape indicates the skills for which you have natural talent. The Talent Landscape and your position within it serve as a compass to help you determine the most suitable career steps, both in education and in jobs.

The Behavioral Cycle

The context in which you find yourself is crucial, as different situations require different actions and behaviors. Our Behavioral Cycle maps out which context best aligns with your brain. The steps in this cycle provide insight into the various ways the brain processes information and takes action. Your Brain Preferences are crucial in understanding whether you thrive best in an environment where, for example, long-term planning and thinking ahead are necessary, or in an environment where matters require ad-hoc attention and constant adaptation.

Your unique profile gives you insights in what you are naturally good at and how you process things. On the next page, we highlight three specific components: your skills, work styles, and a 'typical' workday in your life. From there, we guide you through the Talent Landscape and the Behavioral Cycle.

This profile was generated automatically based on the talent's performance on the BrainsFirst games. The interpretation of this document assumes that the talent has performed the test to the best of their ability. It is also assumes that talents have carried out the test themselves.

Additional material

Like to know more?

Scan QR-code or use this link:

www.brainsfirst.com/candidate-qr-page

Your Personal Overview

Insights into your brain

The following text provides you with a general insight into your brain. Every brain is unique; everyone has their own preferences, strengths, and challenges. Moreover, we are shaped over the years by our experiences and our environment. Based on 5000 data points collected during the NeurOlympics, we determine your position in the Talent Landscape and your Natural Brain Preferences in the Behavioral Cycle.

Your skills in a nutshell

You tend to prefer self-reflection and effective prioritization. You maintain strong control over actions. You show creativity and proactive problem-solving skills. You have a talent for quality control analysis. You excel in conducting tests, identifying issues, and implementing corrective actions, driving continuous improvement for yourself and others.

What your working styles say about you

You have the potential to excel in roles where you lead and inspire others, generate innovative ideas, and demonstrate strong dependability. You have a knack for troubleshooting issues and ensuring quality, and a talent for working with a strategic vision and creativity. You thrive in environments requiring coordination, conflict resolution, and a focus on continuous improvement.

A day in your life

On a typical workday, you start by reviewing the team's progress, quickly spotting inefficiencies and identifying issues before they escalate. As you guide your team, you set clear goals and ensure everyone's on the same page. Later, when an unexpected challenge arises, you calmly adjust priorities, solving problems with creative solutions. You take pride in your reliability, always meeting deadlines and keeping operations running smoothly, while encouraging others to do the same.

Intrigued? Keep reading to gain more personalized insight into your position in the Talent Landscape and what your Behavioral Cycle looks like!

Talent Landscape

Your position in the Talent Landscape

During our gamified assessment, the NeurOlympics, we have measured your personal Brain Profile. Our AI models then compared it to thousands of other individuals, allowing us to position your brain in the Talent Landscape. Your position indicates where your talents lie and what skills you naturally have or can learn quickly.

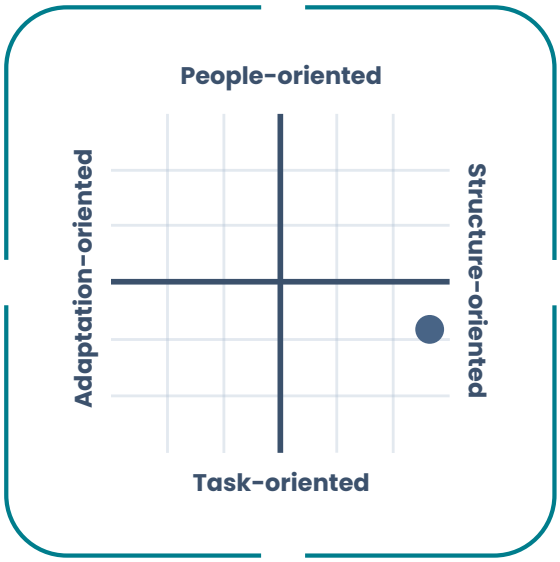
Your brain falls into the Structure & Task-oriented quadrant. Brains in this quadrant typically excel when work processes are well-defined, and the work environment is structured and predictable. Often, the following talents are present: conceptual and abstract thinking, conducting quality controls, analyzing data or information, creative thinking, and showing initiative.

Adaptation & People-oriented

Individuals in this quadrant focus on working for or with people, building and maintaining strong relationships. They are supportive and caring, demonstrating integrity and reliability in their work. Additionally, they are detail-oriented and value accuracy in their tasks.

Structure & People-oriented

Individuals in this quadrant are often involved in coordinating teams and processes. They are strongly focused on building relationships and are supportive and caring. Their approach is methodical, and they are decisive and solution-oriented.



Adaptation & Task-oriented

Individuals in this quadrant are skilled in advising and communicating, effectively conveying information. They are honest and reliable, paying great attention to detail and accuracy. They are organized and systematic in their approach and are critical and inquisitive.

Structure & Task-oriented

Individuals in this quadrant excel in conceptual and abstract thinking. They are methodical in their approach, decisive, and focused on finding solutions. They are organized and follow a systematic approach in their work, being inquisitive and critical.

Top Figure: the dot displays where your brain is located in the Talent Landscape. When it comes to skills that are close to your natural talents, you will excel in them easily or learn them fast.

Scan the QR-code or use this link to read more about the Talent Landscape:

www.brainsfirst.com/resources/our-talent-landscape/

Behavioral Cycle

Your Natural Brain Preferences in the Behavioral Cycle

We have investigated how core Executive Functions differ between people and how this translates into different behaviors. People differ from each other in a number of abilities, which we call Natural Brain Preferences. These describe how people process information from the outside world, think, decide and act in response to this information and anticipate their future actions.

Below you can find your Natural Brain Preferences within our Behavioral Cycle. These are the skills that come naturally to you and will give you insights in which kind of place you can excel with your current skill set.

Some steps in the Behavioral Cycle will be balanced, which indicates that you are able to make use of both styles, depending on what is needed in specific work situations and contexts. In other steps, a clear trade-off or preference will be evident.

This will result in specific and concrete benefits in certain work situations and contexts, but challenges in others.

See page 9-11 for a full explanation of your Top Natural Brain Preferences, strengths, andchallenges.

Scan the QR-code to read more about the Behavioral Cycle or use this link:

www.brainsfirst.com/resources/naturalbrainpreferences

Top Natural Brain Preferences	Strengths
1 **Organized Planning** *Your brain prefers to think ahead and handle complex projects in a structured manner.*	• You structure projects into overviews and tasks • You don't need pressure from deadlines • You can process a lot of information at once
2 **Precise Acting** *Your brain generally works best when quality is paramount.*	• You act with great precision and control • You typically work step by step towards your goal • You can help improve the work of others
3 **Considerate Deciding** *Your brain excels when making informed decisions is necessary.*	• You make balanced, far-reaching decisions • You substantiate all possible choice options • You naturally gain support from others

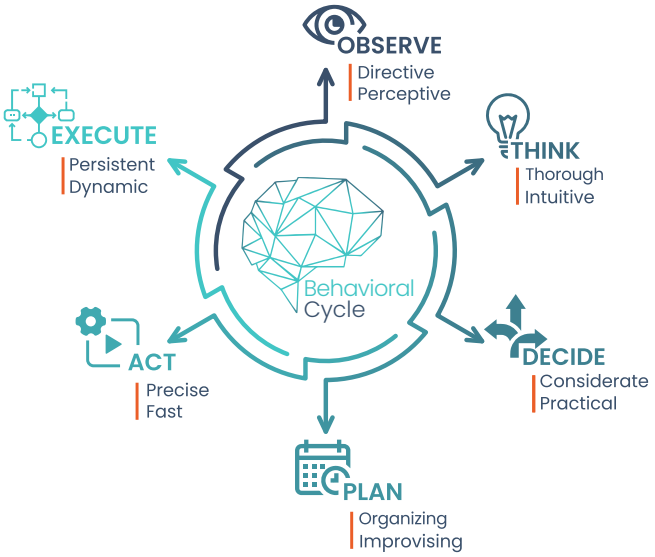
Natural Brain Preferences

Our brain games directly measure the core Executive Functions of your prefrontal cortex, which consist of:
1) Working Memory, 2) Attention, 3) Inhibition, and 4) Cognitive Flexibility.

If you want to know more about the core Executive Functions, please go to page 4 and scan the QR code or click on the link.

Based on years of scientific research, we have investigated how core Executive Functions differ between people and how this translates into different ways of thinking and acting. This is reflexted in six different aspects in our Behavioral Cycle, which we call "Natural Brain Preferences": Observing, Thinking, Deciding, Planning, Acting & Executing. Together these preferences describe how people process information from the outside world, think, decide and act in response to this information and anticipate their future actions.

On the right, you'll see all six steps in the Behavioral Cycle. Everyone has different levels of proficiency in these, and they can be influenced by our individual tendencies. For example, some people may have a tendency to act more slowly but with greater precision (precise acting), while others may act quickly but with less precision (fast acting).



Your Top Brain Preferences

Every person observes, thinks, decides, plans, acts, and executes. So do you! These skills include the way we observe and retain information, how well we can concentrate, how we come to decisions and how we adjust our behavior when the need arises.

On the next pages you'll find your three Top Natural Brain Preferences. These are the abilities that come most naturally to your brain. It's important to realize that this is not the full story of your brain. You can see it as the highlight reel of your neurocognitive skills.

How to get the most out of your brain strengths

For each of your Top Natural Brain Preferences we'll provide you with the situations where you can make the most of your Brain Preferences. Understanding the natural resources your brain provides can help you be more effective in your work.

Working well also means working well with others. Therefore, we also provide tips on how to work together with other brain types in your team.

Working well with others

Each step in the Behavioral Cycle has a complementary Brain Preference that differs from your own Brain Preference. Research has demonstrated that the most effective team outcomes arise from cognitively diverse teams, provided that team members can leverage their unique strengths. This concept operates in two ways. First, it is important to communicate how your brain prefers to operate, so that others can recognize your strengths and needs. This document can serve as a foundation for that communication. Second, it is critical to recognize how other people's brains function, so that you can comprehend their needs and rely on their strengths when necessary. Successful teams are composed of complementary brains that collaborate, resulting in increased team productivity and well-being. The team operates as a whole and is more than the sum of its components.

Top Natural Brain Preferences

1 Organized Planning

Your brain has a preference for thinking ahead and handling complex projects in a structured manner.

You naturally have a tendency to structure and plan tasks and projects well in advance. You generally divide up time into fixed blocks, allowing to see complex projects through to completion. Since you generally have a need for a structured way of working and organizing, you may encounter difficulties if briefings and goals are unclear or if projects are constantly changing. To prevent misunderstandings and ensure success, it is important to communicate the need for clarity in terms of goals.

Common strengths & how to effectively use them

Structure provides stability!
You structure projects into task overviews. Make concrete plans to prioritize effectively.

Who needs deadlines anyway!
You're highly effective at planning ahead. Create a clear vision of where you need to go, and you won't need the pressure of deadlines to shine.

Planning, planning, and more planning!
You can easily process a lot of information at once. Convert this into tasks that you can effectively and efficiently allocate into time blocks!

Potential challenges & how to overcome them

Squeeze this in as well?
You may find it challenging to deal with unexpected things. Try to allocate some extra time in your schedule for ad-hoc tasks and situations to create space for yourself.

What do you mean?
Vague objectives are a thorn in your side. If something is unclear, discuss it immediately with your colleagues for a clear understanding of expectations together.

Did you just think of that now?
You may find it challenging to handle ad-hoc tasks. Discuss with your colleagues that this causes you stress and that you excel more in planned projects.

Work processes involve various tasks, from complex projects to simpler ones like meal prep, and brains approach these tasks differently. Organizing brains prefer to structure tasks ahead of time, organizing them into hierarchies for efficiency. Conversely, Improvising brains adjust plans on-the-fly, displaying flexibility with time and an inclination towards in-the-moment planning, rather than rigidly adhering to preconceived structures. These differing neurocognitive styles showcase how tasks and schedules are uniquely actioned. Planning depends on the dorsolateral perfrontal cortex in combination with the anterior cingulate cortex.

Working with people who Plan in an Improvised way

People who plan in an improvised way often possess different strengths and pitfalls than you do. They can help you by taking on small, ad-hoc tasks, which may not be your strong suit. Even when everything suddenly goes differently than planned, they can help you keep things on track.
In turn, you can support them by breaking down large projects into smaller, more manageable tasks and setting priorities. Or consider taking on some of their long-term projects. Be mindful of their need for flexibility and spontaneity. Overly tight schedules and overly detailed goals may constrain them. Try to communicate openly and flexibly, leaving room for unplanned things. Additionally, be aware that your spontaneous organizational style may pose challenges for colleagues who prefer a more structured approach.

2 Precise Acting

Your brain has a preference for situations and environments where quality is paramount.

You naturally tend to complete fewer tasks in a day but excel at giving attention to detail. You thrive in roles where editing or correcting somebody else's work is crucial or when making mistakes must be prevented at all costs. You require time to do your work, prioritizing quality over quantity. Because you prioritize quality, you may, at times, experience significant time pressure. To ensure that you get your work done, it's important to manage your time effectively. Allocating specific time blocks to each task can be useful, allowing you to prioritize effectively while still delivering high-quality work.

Common strengths & how to effectively use them

It's under control!
You act with precision and control. Take on those complex tasks that nobody wants, especially, and bring them to a successful conclusion!

Dotting the i's!
You excel in tasks where details matter. Work step by step towards the finish line to achieve your goal accurately.

Mistakes, what are those?
You're less prone to making mistakes due to your precise way of working. Offer assistance to others to help them improve the quality!

Potential challenges & how to overcome them

Is there any time left?
Because you work very precisely, it takes longer to complete tasks. Try to schedule fixed time blocks for specific tasks with specific deadlines.

Should I add that to the list as well?
Because you want to do tasks very precisely, it can sometimes feel overwhelming when more tasks keep piling up. Try to be sharp with your priorities and discuss what you can delegate with your colleagues.

Sometimes, an 8 is good enough!
Due to your pursuit of perfection, you may feel stressed. Discuss with your colleagues and stakeholders when the output is good enough, and involve them in assessing the outcome periodically.

Brains vary significantly in the way they act, with some moving slower but with greater precision, while others prioritize speed despite the increased chance of errors. Precise brains utilize the supplementary motor cortex and inferior frontal gyrus, continually adjusting motor areas for increased accuracy. This method, while reliable, is not swift. On the other hand, Fast Acting brains rely on a more direct pathway from information processing to action, utilizing the motor cortex and the cerebellum. While these brains act swiftly, they may have less accuracy.

Working with people who Act Fast

People who act fast often possess different strengths and pitfalls than you do. They can assist you in getting work done quickly and accomplishing a lot in a short time, but they may leave some minor imperfections in their work. Try asking them to handle the preliminary work, after which you can add the finishing touches.
In turn, you can help them with precision work. They may make mistakes on important tasks due to their high work pace. Offer to take over certain precision tasks from them or to check their work. Show understanding that they work quickly but are also prone to errors. This way, you can collectively accomplish the workload of three people.

3 Considerate Deciding

Your brain has a preference for situations where decisions need to be made in an informed and deliberate way.

You naturally tend to examine all available options and value the input of others. This means taking a thorough approach to decision-making and striving to consider all angles. You may also be naturally inclined to consider the long-term consequences of decisions. Since you weigh many decision options and value consensus when making decisions, it can lead to delays in the decision-making process. Finding a balance between thorough consideration and timely decision-making is key.

Common strengths & how to effectively use them

All information sorted!
When making decisions, you carefully consider all options. Seek out relevant information and take it into account in your decision-making process.

Here are the options!
You can substantiate and list choice options well. Make a list of your options, including the long-term consequences, so you can share them clearly at a glance!

Everyone agrees!
You naturally create support for your choices. KUse this strength to involve others in decision-making.

Potential challenges & how to overcome them

Do I have enough information?
Wanting to consider all information in a decision-making process can lead to delays. Try to limit your choices to a maximum of three options.

Do you agree?
At times, you can become too dependent on your colleagues for the next step. Try making a decision independently and then validating it, rather than co-creating.

Where did the time go?
You enjoy taking your time with decisions, but sometimes this causes significant delays. Try setting a time limit for a decision; this will force you to focus on the main goal.

Our brain, tasked with many decisions daily, uses different styles for complex choices. The superior prefrontal cortex, allowing for thoughtful decisions, carefully evaluates pros and cons. In contrast, the premotor cortex supports practical, goal-directed decisions. Some brains lean towards practicality, while others emphasize thoroughness in their decision-making process. These decisions range from automatic ones like braking the car to deliberate ones such as choosing a seat on a train. The nuanced role of the brain in decision-making underscores its versatility and adaptability in different situations.

Working with people who Decide Practically

People who decide practical often possess different strengths and pitfalls than you do. They can help you speed up the decision-making process. If you find yourself stuck in a decision-making process, ask them which decision will lead you to your goal most quickly or effectively. Also, seek their help in defining situations where you can make decisions independently.
In turn, you can help them make decisions that involve a certain level of risk. In such cases, offer to map out all the options along with their pros and cons, consistently highlighting the potential risks of each choice. Additionally, you can help create consensus to ensure widespread support, a skill that comes naturally to you.

Scientific Explanation

Based on years of neuroscience research

Our gamified assessment games are the result of over 10 years of neuroscientific research into the basic building blocks of human performance. This allows us to measure the deep skills we all have, based on the natural talents of our brains.

How do the games work?

Each of the four games work very intuitively. You click on disappearing cells or shoot at falling cells. The games are crafted in a way that allow us to ask your brain very specific questions. For example: What happens in your brain when you are just about to perform an action and have to stop at the very last moment? Does your brain prefer speed or precision when it is put under pressure? We record your behavior while you do these tests: your responses and response times. These answers tell something about the very basic building blocks of your brain. We record over thousands of data points in each session. We combine subsets of these data points to construct values on 12 different Natural Brain Preferences.

What are these Natural Brain Preferences?

Executive function is a term used in neuroscience to describe a set of cognitive abilities that are responsible for our ability to plan and carry out tasks. These abilities involve different parts of our brain working together to help us focus our attention, control our impulses, and make decisions.

Think of it like a conductor leading an orchestra. Just as the conductor needs to coordinate the different sections of the orchestra to create a harmonious piece of music, our brain's executive function coordinates different parts of our brain to help us achieve our goals.

There are six steps in the Behavioral Cycle derived from executive function: Observing, Thinking, Deciding, Planning, Acting, and Executing. These skills work together to help us process information from the outside world, make decisions, and take action in response to that information.

It's important to note that everyone has different levels of proficiency when it comes to these skills, and that they can be influenced by our individual tendencies or preferences. For example, some people may have a tendency to act more slowly but with greater precision (precise acting), while others may act quickly but with less precision (fast acting).

Is that all there is?

Each individual brain is a very complicated organ that is impossible to capture in just six variables. However, an analysis with thousands of people have shown that the positions on these six steps in the Behavioral Cycle represent 85% of the variance in the executive functions that we measure. We use these Natural Brain Preferences predict if a brain is a natural match for a certain job or function. We have shown that we are very well able to accomplish this.

What about intelligence?

Traditional intelligence tests measure a general level of intelligence. However, it has been found that it is not a reliable measure to predict performance within a certain job. The NeurOlympics measure cognitive skills such as decision-making, speed, anticipation, accuracy and concentration. All these skills are of greater importance than a traditional measure of intelligence when it comes to job performance and happiness.

Want to know more?

There are several books available to tell you more about the prefrontal cortex and the executive functions made possible by the prefrontal cortex. We recommend that you read the book "Your Brain at Work" by David Rock if you want to make better use of your prefrontal cortex. If you want to learn more about executive functions, read the scientific article "Executive Functions" by Adele Diamond. You can find information on all of this on our website. Please scan the QR code/click on the link below for more information.

Additional material

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BrainsFirst

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